

PORTER & KOVAL PLUMBING LLC

Employee Handbook 2026 Edition

Licensed Master Plumbing & Community Construction
Residential · Commercial · New Construction · Emergency Service

1842 East Susquehanna Avenue, Fishtown, Philadelphia, PA 19125
Office (215) 555-0188 · PA Master Plumber License MP-044219
Established 2012 · Pennsylvania Limited Liability Company

This handbook is the property of Porter & Koval Plumbing LLC and is issued to employees for reference. It is not an employment contract.

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Porter & Koval Plumbing was founded in 2012 by master plumber Emily Porter and business partner Kevin Koval. The shop serves greater Philadelphia from its Fishtown base, with a field crew that works residential service, commercial accounts, and new construction across the river wards. This handbook collects the shop's standing policies in one place so every member of the crew works from the same page.

1 Company Overview & Mission

Porter & Koval Plumbing LLC is a licensed, bonded, and insured plumbing contractor registered in the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania. The shop was built on the belief that work done well is the most honest expression of character, and that a clean joint, an honest invoice, and a customer treated squarely are what keep a trade business alive across generations in a neighborhood.

Ownership & Leadership

Role	Held by	Responsibility
Master Plumber & Field Lead	Emily Porter	Licensing, field quality, code compliance, crew direction
Partner & Operations	Kevin Koval	Sales, estimates, scheduling, bookkeeping, payroll
Journeyman Plumbers	Miguel Santos, Phil Brennan	Independent scopes on residential and commercial jobs
Apprentice	Jake Boyko	Supervised field work toward journeyman hours

Service Area & Work

The shop's core service area is Fishtown, Kensington, Northern Liberties, Frankford, and Port Richmond, with commercial accounts reaching across the city. Work spans new construction rough-in and finish, remodels, emergency repairs, backflow prevention, and water-heater installation. Key accounts include three property-management companies and two restaurant groups, alongside a steady base of residential referrals.

What We Value On Every Job

- Show up when we said we would, and call ahead if the truck is running behind.
- Leave the customer's property cleaner than we found it — drop cloths down, water off, mess hauled out.
- Quote straight, bill straight, and never pad a line a customer cannot see the value in.
- Treat every apprentice hour as training, not cheap labor. The trade is passed down or it is lost.

2 Employment Basics

Equal Opportunity

Porter & Koval is an equal-opportunity employer. Hiring, pay, assignment, and advancement decisions are made on the basis of skill, license standing, reliability, and conduct, without regard to race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, or any other status protected by federal or Pennsylvania law.

At-Will Employment

Employment with the shop is at will. Either the employee or the shop may end the relationship at any time, with or without cause and with or without notice. Nothing in this handbook creates a contract of employment or a guarantee of continued employment, and only the owners may alter the at-will relationship, in writing and signed.

Classification

Class	Definition	Eligibility
Full-time field	Regularly scheduled 40 hours per week	Full benefits after 60 days
Part-time / seasonal	Fewer than 30 hours or a defined season	Pro-rated PTO only
Apprentice	Registered apprentice logging supervised hours	Benefits at full-time hours

Licensing & Certification

Every field crew member must hold and maintain the certifications their role requires under Pennsylvania and City of Philadelphia code. The shop tracks license and certification expirations and will not dispatch an out-of-compliance crew member to a permitted job. Renewal of a personal trade license is the crew member's responsibility; the shop reimburses the renewal fee on proof of current standing.

3 Hours & Compensation

Standard Schedule

The standard work week is Monday through Friday. Field crews load out from the Susquehanna Avenue shop at the start of the day and are expected on the first job site shortly after, returning to the shop or closing out on site by mid-afternoon. Saturday work is scheduled on a rotating basis during busy season and is paid at the overtime rate.

Item	Detail
Shop load-out	6:30 a.m. Eastern from the Fishtown shop
Target on first site	7:00 a.m. Eastern
Standard day ends	3:30 p.m. Eastern, on site or back at the shop
Saturday rotation	Busy-season only, paid at overtime rate
Meal break	30 minutes unpaid on any shift over 6 hours

Pay Schedule

Pay is issued biweekly by direct deposit. Payroll is processed every other Friday and funds land the following business day. Pay stubs are available through the payroll portal. Overtime is paid at one and one-half times the regular rate for any hours worked over forty in a single work week.

Time & Attendance

Time is captured two ways: the time clock at the shop for load-out and return, and field time entry in the mobile app for on-site hours. Crew members are responsible for entering job and phase codes so hours land against the right job for costing. Missing or mis-coded time must be corrected before the pay period closes on the second Friday.

4 Time Off & Leave

Paid Time Off

Paid time off accrues with tenure and is requested through the PTO form in the HR system. PTO should be requested as far ahead as feasible so scheduling can cover the job board; requests during peak commercial phases may be held pending crew coverage.

Length of service	PTO accrual	Sick time
Year 1 through Year 3	3 weeks (15 days) per year	1 day per month worked
Year 4 and beyond	4 weeks (20 days) per year	1 day per month worked

Sick time accrues separately from PTO at one day per month of work and may be used for the employee's own illness or to care for a household member. Sick time does not pay out on separation.

Observed Holidays

Holiday	Holiday
New Year's Day	Labor Day
Memorial Day	Thanksgiving Day and the day after
Independence Day	Christmas Eve and Christmas Day

Other Leave

- **Bereavement:** up to three paid days for a death in the immediate family.
- **Jury duty:** paid for the term of service on presentation of the summons.
- **Unpaid personal leave:** may be granted at the owners' discretion when PTO is exhausted.

5 Standards of Conduct

On the Customer Site

Field crew members represent the shop on every customer site. Conduct is expected to be professional, respectful of customer property, and aligned with the brand voice described in the shop brand guidelines. Loud language, off-color talk, and phone calls in a customer's home are out of place. When a customer asks a question outside the scope of the job, the answer is to loop in Emily or Kevin, not to freelance a quote.

Tools & Materials

Tools and materials assigned to a crew member are that crew member's responsibility. Loss or damage resulting from negligence may be deducted from the final paycheck to the extent permitted under Pennsylvania law. Shop tools go back on the truck board at the end of the day; a missing tool is reported, not quietly replaced.

Substance Use

Reporting to a job site or operating shop equipment under the influence of alcohol or drugs is grounds for immediate termination. The shop participates in random drug testing on a quarterly basis and reserves the right to test after any recordable job-site incident.

Confidentiality

Customer addresses, access codes, financial details, and job pricing are confidential. Photos of finished work may be used for the shop's portfolio only with no customer identifying detail, and never shared to a personal account.

6 Health, Safety & Vehicles

Certification & Training

Every crew member must complete the OSHA 10-hour construction course within the first ninety days of employment and maintain current standing. Additional certifications (backflow, hot-work, confined-space) are required by role and paid for by the shop.

Personal Protective Equipment

Situation	Required PPE
Any customer site	Safety glasses, work boots, gloves
Power equipment / cutting	Hearing protection and eye protection
Torch / hot work	Fire-rated gloves, extinguisher staged within reach
Confined space / crawl	Air monitor, knee protection, spotter present

Incident Reporting

Incident reporting is mandatory. Any injury, near miss, or property damage on a customer site must be reported to the shop lead within four hours of the event, with photos where safe to take them. Prompt reporting protects the crew member, the customer, and the shop's insurance standing.

Company Vehicles

Shop vehicles, including the F-250, are for shop business only. Drivers must hold a valid license and report any moving violation. A daily walk-around and the maintenance log keep the truck road-ready; fuel receipts are turned in with weekly paperwork.

7 Pay, Benefits & Retirement

Health Coverage

Health insurance is offered through the small-business marketplace to full-time crew after the introductory period. The shop contributes toward the premium as shown below; the employee share is deducted pre-tax from payroll.

Coverage tier	Shop contribution	Employee share
Employee only	70% of premium	30% of premium
Employee + dependents	50% of dependent premium	50% of dependent premium

Retirement

Retirement savings are offered through a SIMPLE IRA plan. The shop matches employee contributions dollar for dollar up to three percent of compensation. Enrollment opens at the introductory period and during the annual election window.

Continuing Education

The shop supports crew members who advance in the trade. Approved courses related to plumbing, backflow, or supervisory skills are reimbursed at one hundred percent on successful completion, and license-renewal fees are covered on proof of current standing. Time spent in required certification is treated as paid work time.

Other Benefits

- Shop-provided uniforms and a boot allowance each season.
- Tool-purchase program with payroll deduction at cost for personal hand tools.
- Referral bonus when a crew member brings in a hire who clears the introductory period.

8 Training & Apprenticeship

The shop runs a structured apprenticeship aimed at carrying crew members from helper hours to a journeyman card and, in time, toward a master license. Apprentices are paired with a journeyman or with Emily on jobs chosen for their teaching value, and supervised hours are logged toward Pennsylvania requirements. Field learning is backed by the shop curriculum and periodic sign-off on demonstrated skills.

- Every apprentice hour is a training hour — scopes are chosen to build skill, not just to fill a truck.
- A journeyman signs off on a demonstrated skill before an apprentice runs it unsupervised.
- The shop covers exam fees and study materials for the journeyman and master examinations.

9 Separation & Return of Property

Either the shop or the employee may end the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause and with or without notice. As a courtesy, the shop asks for two weeks' notice when feasible so the job board can be covered.

Final pay, including any earned but unused PTO, is issued on the next regular payroll date following separation. Return of shop property — tools, vehicle keys, uniforms, access cards, and any printed materials — is required before the final paycheck is released, to the extent permitted under Pennsylvania law.

Employee Acknowledgment

I acknowledge that I have received the Porter & Koval Plumbing LLC Employee Handbook, 2026 Edition. I understand that it describes the shop's current policies and that it is not an employment contract or a guarantee of continued employment. I understand that my employment is at will, and that the shop may update these policies from time to time. I agree to read the handbook, ask about anything I do not understand, and follow the standards of conduct and safety set out in it.

Employee name (print)	Signature	Date
Reviewed by (owner)	Signature	Date

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